THE GOSPEL VAULT · VAULT 1 · THE GOSPEL · CHARTS

Eternal Life / Salvation: God's Free Gift

A six-panel walkthrough of what the Bible — especially the Gospel of John — says it takes to receive eternal life, and what it does not.

1 The Question	2 Why John's Gospel	3 Believe	4 No Additions	5 Assurance	6 In Every Language

Ten charts + John 3:16 in 48 languages · Ephesians 2:8–9 · 1 John 5:13 · thegospelvault.com

Six panels, one argument

The walkthrough at a glance · thegospelvault.com/free-gift

1 The Question

Salvation is a free gift — so what do you actually have to do to receive it?

2 Why John's Gospel

One Gospel states its purpose outright: "that you may believe."

3 Believe

The one condition, pictured six ways: look, hear, enter, drink, come, receive.

4 No Additions

No qualifiers on faith, and no repentance or surrender tacked on as extra conditions.

5 Assurance

You can know — not just hope — that you have eternal life.

6 In Every Language

John 3:16 — the same promise in 48 languages, to share in someone else's own tongue.

"For by grace you have been saved through faith; and that not of yourselves, it is the gift of God." — Ephesians 2:8

A free gift — or a gift with a price tag?

Panel 1 · The Question · Ephesians 2:8–9; Romans 4:5; 5:1

What Scripture says the gift is

Eph 2:8–9
By grace … through faith … the gift of God; not as a result of works

Rom 4:5
To the one who does not work, but believes … his faith is credited as righteousness

Rom 5:1
Having been justified by faith, we have peace with God

vs

The price tags people add

- Repent of your sins
- Confess Jesus before others
- Ask Him into your heart
- Make Him Lord of your life
- Promise to serve Him
- Go forward at church
- Join a church
- Be baptized
- Make a decision for Christ
- Accept Him as Lord and Savior

Some of these may be good things a believer eventually does — but is any one of them the condition for receiving eternal life?

Four Gospels, four portraits — one stated purpose

Panel 2 · Why John's Gospel · Matt 23:37; Mark 10:45; Luke 19:10; John 20:30–31

Matthew The King of Israel	**Mark** The Suffering Servant	**Luke** The Son of Man	**John** The Christ, the Son of God
Longing over Jerusalem like a hen gathering her chicks	Came not to be served, but to serve, and to give His life a ransom for many	Came to seek and to save that which was lost	*"These have been written so that you may believe … and that believing you may have life in His name"*
Matt 23:37–39	Mark 10:45	Luke 19:10	John 20:30–31

Matthew, Mark and Luke show their purpose through what they chose. John states his outright — he wrote to answer exactly this question.

One sentence, three things

Panel 2 · Why John's Gospel · John 20:31; John 1:1

"…these have been written so that you may believe that Jesus is the Christ, the Son of God; and that believing you may have life in His name." — John 20:31

1

Who Jesus is

The Christ, the Son of God — fully God: "In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was God"

John 1:1

2

The response He is after

Believe — not do, promise, or perform

John 20:31a

3

What it gets you

Life in His name — eternal life

John 20:31b

If you want to know what it takes to receive eternal life, this is the Gospel written specifically to answer that.

"Believe" — the word John built his Gospel on

Panel 3 · Believe · Count of "believe" in the New Testament

98

times in John

34

in Matthew, Mark and Luke combined

16

in the rest of the New Testament

What it means: to trust in someone, convinced that what he said is true. Faith in John is trusted reliance on Christ's promise to give eternal life to those who believe.

"He who hears My word, and believes Him who sent Me, has eternal life … and has passed out of death into life." — John 5:24 · Present tense, settled now.

Six pictures, one act

Panel 3 · Believe · How John pictures believing

Look
John 3:14–15

As Moses lifted up the serpent … whoever believes will in Him have eternal life

Hear
John 10:16, 27

My sheep hear My voice, and I know them, and they follow Me

Enter
John 10:9

I am the door; if anyone enters through Me, he will be saved

Drink
John 4:14

Whoever drinks of the water that I will give him shall never thirst

Come
John 5:40; 6:37; 7:37

The one who comes to Me I will certainly not cast out

Receive
John 1:12

As many as received Him, to them He gave the right to become children of God

Simple trust in what Christ has promised — nothing hidden, nothing added.

No qualifiers on faith

Panel 4 · No Additions · John uses "true" — but never on believing

Where John does write "true"

- the true light — John 1:9
- true worshippers — John 4:23
- the true bread — John 6:32
- disciples indeed — John 8:31
- the true vine — John 15:1
- the true God — John 17:3

vs

What John never writes

- ✕ "whoever really believes"
- ✕ "whoever truly believes"
- ✕ "genuine faith"
- ✕ "real faith"
- ✕ "effectual faith"

One either believes, or he does not believe. There is no hidden second tier of "believing enough."

No extra conditions standing next to faith

Panel 4 · No Additions · John 4:10, 14; 12:42; 19:38–39

Repentance?

The Samaritan woman was never told to repent. Jesus offered her eternal life for the asking and the drinking — both pictures of believing.

Repentance as a change of mind happens as a person believes — not a separate work on top of faith.

John 4:10, 14

Commitment?

Salvation is received, not earned or bargained for. A believer gives his life to Christ after believing.

Commitment follows salvation; it does not purchase it.

Free gift

Public confession?

Joseph of Arimathea, Nicodemus and some of the rulers believed but, out of fear, did not confess Jesus openly.

John still counts them among those who believed.

John 12:42; 19:38–39

Faith alone in Christ alone — a simple, unconditional, non-meritorious response of accepting and trusting God's promise.

You can know you have eternal life

Panel 5 · Assurance · John 1:29; 3:16; 20:31; 1 John 5:11–13

1

Faith needs an object

Not believing hard enough, but who you trust: the Son of God (20:31), the Lamb who takes away sin (1:29), risen (John 20).

2

Invite people to believe

Not "ask Jesus into your heart," "give your life," or "surrender as Lord" — believe in Christ as Savior.

3

Assurance rests on the Word

Not on feelings, performance, or a memorable moment. God's own testimony is sufficient.

4

Keep the gospel free

The sin that condemns is unbelief; the cure for unbelief is belief in what Christ has finished.

"These things I have written to you who believe … so that you may know that you have eternal life." — 1 John 5:13
Not hope. Not guess. Know.

Not because your faith was strong enough, but because His promise was.

PANEL 6 · IN EVERY LANGUAGE

"For God so loved the world, that He gave His only begotten Son, that whoever believes in Him shall not perish, but have eternal life."

John 3:16 · NASB95 — and the same promise in all 48 languages on the slides that follow

Chinese (Simplified)	Hindi	Spanish	Arabic	French	Portuguese
Bengali	Indonesian	Urdu	Russian	German	Swahili
Japanese	Marathi	Vietnamese	Telugu	Turkish	Tagalog
Hausa	Punjabi	Tamil	Persian	Korean	Amharic
Thai	Javanese	Italian	Gujarati	Kannada	Yoruba
Nigerian Pidgin	Chinese (Traditional)	Malayalam	Polish	Igbo	Ukrainian
Burmese	Odia	Malay	Afaan Oromo	Nepali	Dutch
Romanian	Sinhala	Khmer	Zulu	Cebuano	Pashto

Believe His promise today — in your own language.

John 3:16 in 48 languages

Panel 6 · In Every Language · 1–6 of 48 · 1 of 8

Chinese (Simplified) · China

约翰福音 3:16 • CUV 和合本

神爱世人，甚至将他的独生子赐给他们，叫一切信他的，不至灭亡，反得永生。

Hindi · India

यूहन्ना 3:16 · IRV

क्योंकि परमेश्वर ने जगत से ऐसा प्रेम रखा कि उसने अपना एकलौता पुत्र दे दिया, ताकि जो कोई उस पर विश्वास करे, वह नाश न हो, परन्तु अनन्त जीवन पाए।

Spanish · Latin America

Juan 3:16 · RVR1960

Porque de tal manera amó Dios al mundo, que ha dado a su Hijo unigénito, para que todo aquel que en él cree, no se pierda, mas tenga vida eterna.

Arabic · Arab World

يوحنا 3:16 · VAN DYCK

لِأَنَّهُ هَكَذَا أَحَبَّ ٱللهُ ٱلْعَالَمَ حَتَّى بَذَلَ ٱبْنَهُ ٱلْوَحِيدَ، لِكَيْ لَا يَهْلِكَ كُلُّ مَنْ يُؤْمِنُ بِهِ، بَلْ تَكُونُ لَهُ ٱلْحَيَاةُ ٱلْأَبَدِيَّةُ.

French · France

Jean 3:16 · LOUIS SEGOND

Car Dieu a tant aimé le monde qu'il a donné son Fils unique, afin que quiconque croit en lui ne périsse point, mais qu'il ait la vie éternelle.

Portuguese · Brazil

João 3:16 · ARC 2009

Porque Deus amou o mundo de tal maneira que deu o seu Filho unigênito, para que todo aquele que nele crê não pereça, mas tenha a vida eterna.

John 3:16 in 48 languages

Panel 6 · In Every Language · 7–12 of 48 · 2 of 8

Bengali · Bangladesh

যোহন 3:16 · IRV

কারণ ঈশ্বর জগৎকে এত ভালবাসলেন যে, নিজের একমাত্র পুত্রকে দান করলেন, যেন যে কেউ তাঁতে বিশ্বাস করে সে বিনষ্ট না হয় কিন্তু অনন্ত জীবন পায়।

Indonesian · Indonesia

Yohanes 3:16 · TB

Karena begitu besar kasih Allah akan dunia ini, sehingga Ia telah mengaruniakan Anak-Nya yang tunggal, supaya setiap orang yang percaya kepada-Nya tidak binasa, melainkan beroleh hidup yang kekal.

Urdu · Pakistan

یوحنا 3:16 · GEO VERSION

کیونکہ اللہ نے دنیا سے ایسی محبت رکھی کہ اُس نے اپنے اکلوتے فرزند کو بخش دیا، تاکہ جو کوئی اُس پر ایمان لائے ہلاک نہ ہو بلکہ ہمیشہ کی زندگی پائے۔

Russian · Russia

Иоанна 3:16 · SYNODAL

Ибо так возлюбил Бог мир, что отдал Сына Своего Единородного, дабы всякий верующий в Него, не погиб, но имел жизнь вечную.

German · Germany

Johannes 3:16 · LUTHER 1912

Also hat Gott die Welt geliebt, daß er seinen eingeborenen Sohn gab, auf daß alle, die an ihn glauben, nicht verloren werden, sondern das ewige Leben haben.

Swahili · East Africa

Yohana 3:16 · SUV

Kwa maana jinsi hii Mungu aliupenda ulimwengu, hata akamtoa Mwanawe pekee, ili kila mtu amwaminiye asipotee, bali awe na uzima wa milele.

John 3:16 in 48 languages

Panel 6 · In Every Language · 13–18 of 48 · 3 of 8

Japanese · Japan

ヨハネ 3:16 · 新共同訳

神は、その独り子をお与えになったほどに、世を愛された。独り子を信じる者が一人も滅びないで、永遠の命を得るためである。

Marathi · India

योहान 3:16 · IRV

कारण देवाने जगावर एवढी प्रीती केली की, त्याने आपला एकुलता एक पुत्र दिला यासाठी की, जो कोणी त्याच्यावर विश्वास ठेवतो त्याचा नाश होऊ नये तर त्यास सार्वकालिक जीवन मिळावे.

Vietnamese · Vietnam

Giăng 3:16 · VIE2010

Vì Đức Chúa Trời yêu thương thế gian đến nỗi đã ban Con Một của Ngài, hầu cho hễ ai tin Con ấy không bị hư mất mà được sự sống đời đời.

Telugu · India

యోహాను 3:16 · IRV

దేవుడు లోకాన్ని ఎంతో ప్రేమించాడు. అందుకే తన ఏకైక కుమారుణ్ణి ఈ లోకానికి ఇచ్చాడు. తద్వారా ఆయనలో విశ్వాసం ఉంచే ప్రతి వాడూ నశించకుండా నిత్యజీవం పొందుతాడు.

Turkish · Turkey

Yuhanna 3:16 · TCL02

Çünkü Tanrı dünyayı o kadar çok sevdi ki, biricik Oğlu'nu verdi. Öyle ki, O'na iman edenlerin hiçbiri mahvolmasın, hepsi sonsuz yaşama kavuşsun.

Tagalog · Philippines

Juan 3:16 · ABTAG 2001

Sapagkat gayon na lamang ang pag-ibig ng Diyos sa sanlibutan na ibinigay niya ang kanyang tanging Anak, upang ang sinumang sa kanya'y sumampalataya ay huwag mapahamak kundi magkaroon ng buhay na walang hanggan.

John 3:16 in 48 languages

Panel 6 · In Every Language · 19–24 of 48 · 4 of 8

Hausa · Nigeria

Yah 3:16 · HAU

Saboda ƙaunar da Allah ya yi wa duniya har ya ba da makaɗaicin Ɗansa, domin duk wanda ya gaskata da shi kada ya hallaka, sai dai ya sami rai madawwami.

Punjabi · India

ਯੂਹੰਨਾ 3:16 · IRV

ਪਰਮੇਸ਼ੁਰ ਨੇ ਸੰਸਾਰ ਨੂੰ ਇੰਨ੍ਹਾਂ ਪਿਆਰ ਕੀਤਾ ਅਤੇ ਉਸ ਨੇ ਉਨ੍ਹਾਂ ਨੂੰ ਆਪਣਾ ਇੱਕਲੌਤਾ ਪੁੱਤਰ ਦੇ ਦਿੱਤਾ ਤਾਂ ਜੋ ਕੋਈ ਵੀ ਉਸ ਵਿੱਚ ਵਿਸ਼ਵਾਸ ਰੱਖੇ ਉਹ ਨਾਸ ਨਾ ਹੋਵੇ ਸਗੋਂ ਸਦੀਪਕ ਜੀਵਨ ਪ੍ਰਾਪਤ ਕਰੇ ।

Tamil · India

யோவான் 3:16 · IRV

தேவன், தம்முடைய ஒரேபேரான குமாரனின் விசுவாசிக்கிறவன் எவனோ அவன் கெட்டுப்போகாமல் நித்தியஜீவனைப் பெறும்படிக்கு, அவரைக் கொடுத்து, இவ்வளவாய் உலகத்தில் அன்பு செலுத்தினார்.

Persian · Iran

3:16 یوحنا · PERSIAN OLD VERSION

زیرا خدا جهان را اینقدر محبت نمود که پسر یگانه خود را داد تا هر که بر او ایمان آورد هلاک نگردد بلکه حیات جاودانی یابد.

Korean · South Korea

요한복음 3:16 · 개역한글 KRV

하나님이 세상을 이처럼 사랑하사 독생자를 주셨으니 이는 저를 믿는 자마다 멸망치 않고 영생을 얻게 하려 하심이니라

Amharic · Ethiopia

የዮሐንስ 3:16 · አማ54

በእርሱ የሚያምን ሁሉ የዘላለም ሕይወት እንዲኖረው እንጂ እንዳይጠፋ እግዚአብሔር አንድያ ልጁን እስኪሰጥ ድረስ ዓለሙን እንዲሁ ወዶአልና።

John 3:16 in 48 languages

Panel 6 · In Every Language · 25–30 of 48 · 5 of 8

Thai · Thailand

ยอห์น 3:16 · THSV11

พระเจ้าทรงรักโลกดังนี้ คือได้ประทานพระบุตรองค์เดียวของพระองค์ เพื่อทุกคนที่วางใจในพระบุตรนั้นจะไม่พินาศ แต่มีชีวิตนิรันดร์

Javanese · Indonesia

Yokanan 3:16 · KITAB SUTJI

Awitdene Gusti Allah anggone ngasihi marang jagad iku nganti masrahake Kang Putra ontang-anting, supaya saben wong kang pracaya marang Panjenengane aja nganti nemu karusakan, nanging nduwenana urip langgeng.

Italian · Italy

Giovanni 3:16 · NR 2006

Perché Dio ha tanto amato il mondo, che ha dato il suo unigenito Figlio, affinché chiunque crede in lui non perisca, ma abbia vita eterna.

Gujarati · India

યોહાન 3:16 · IRV

કેમ કે ઈશ્વરે માનવજગત પર એટલો બધો પ્રેમ કર્યો કે તેમણે પોતાના એકનો એક દીકરો આપ્યો, એ સારુ કે જે કોઈ તેમના પર વિશ્વાસ કરે તેનો નાશ ન થાય પણ તે અનંતજીવન પામે.

Kannada · India

ಯೋಹಾನ 3:16 · IRV

ದೇವರು ಲೋಕದ ಮೇಲೆ ಎಷ್ಟೋ ಪ್ರೀತಿಯನ್ನಿಟ್ಟು ತನ್ನ ಒಬ್ಬನೇ ಮಗನನ್ನು ಕೊಟ್ಟನು ಆತನನ್ನು ನಂಬುವ ಒಬ್ಬನಾದರೂ ನಾಶವಾಗದೆ ಎಲ್ಲರೂ ನಿತ್ಯಜೀವವನ್ನು ಪಡೆಯಬೇಕೆಂದು ಆತನನ್ನು ಕೊಟ್ಟನು.

Yoruba · Nigeria

Johanu 3:16 · YBCV

Nitori Ọlọrun fẹ araiye tobẹ gẹ, ti o fi Ọmọ bíbi rẹ̀ kanṣoṣo funni, ki ẹnikẹni ti o ba gbà a gbọ́ má bà ṣegbé, ṣugbọn ki o le ni ìye ainipẹkun.

John 3:16 in 48 languages

Panel 6 · In Every Language · 31–36 of 48 · 6 of 8

Nigerian Pidgin · Nigeria

John 3:16 · WBT

God love di pipol wey dey dis world well-well, so E kon send di only pikin wey E get to us, so dat anybody wey bilive am, nor go die, but e go get life wey nor dey end.

Chinese (Traditional) · Taiwan

約翰福音 3:16 • CUV 和合本

神愛世人，甚至將他的獨生子賜給他們，叫一切信他的，不至滅亡，反得永生。

Malayalam · India

യോഹന്നാൻ 3:16 · IRV

തന്റെ ഏകജാതനായ പുത്രനിൽ വിശ്വസിക്കുന്ന ഏവനും നശിച്ചുപോകാതെ നിത്യജീവൻ പ്രാപിക്കേണ്ടതിന് ദൈവം അവനെ നല്കുവാൻ തക്കവണ്ണം ലോകത്തെ സ്നേഹിച്ചു.

Polish · Poland

Jana 3:16 · BW1975

Albowiem tak Bóg umiłował świat, że Syna swego jednorodzonego dał, aby każdy, kto weń wierzy, nie zginął, ale miał żywot wieczny.

Igbo · Nigeria

Jon 3:16 · BIBLE NSO

N'ihi na Chineke huru uwa n'anya otú a, na Ọ nyere ọbuná Ọkpara Ọ muru nání Ya, ka onye ọ bula nke kwere na Ya we ghara ila n'iyì, kama ka o nwe ndu ebighi-ebi.

Ukrainian · Ukraine

Від Івана 3:16 · ОГІЄНКА

Так бо Бог полюбив світ, що дав Сина Свого Однородженого, щоб кожен, хто вірує в Нього, не згинув, але мав життя вічне.

John 3:16 in 48 languages

Panel 6 · In Every Language · 37–42 of 48 · 7 of 8

Burmese · Myanmar

ရှင်ယောဟန် 3:16 · JUDSON

ဘုရားသခင်၏သားတော်ကို ယုံကြည်သော သူအပေါင်းတို့သည်၊ ပျက်စီးခြင်းသို့မရောက်၊ ထာဝရအသက်ကို ရစေခြင်းငှါ၊ ဘုရားသခင်သည် မိမိ၌ တပါးတည်းသော သားတော်ကို စွန့်တော်မူသည်တိုင်အောင် လောကီသားကို ချစ်တော်မူ၏။။

Odia · India

ଯୋହନ 3:16 · IRV

କାରଣ ଈଶ୍ୱରର ଜଗତକୁ ଏଡ଼େ ପ୍ରେମ କଲେ ଯେ, ସେ ଆପଣା ଅଦ୍ୱିତୀୟ ପୁତ୍ରଙ୍କୁ ଦାନ କଲେ, ଯେପରି ଯେ କେହି ତାହାଙ୍କଠାରେ ବିଶ୍ୱାସ କରେ, ସେ ବିନଷ୍ଟ ନ ହୋଇ ଅନନ୍ତ ଜୀବନ ପ୍ରାପ୍ତ ହୁଏ ।

Malay · Malaysia

Yohanes 3:16 · BERITA BAIK

Allah sangat mengasihi orang di dunia ini sehingga Dia memberikan Anak-Nya yang tunggal, supaya setiap orang yang percaya kepada Anak itu tidak binasa tetapi beroleh hidup sejati dan kekal.

Afaan Oromo · Ethiopia

Yohannis 3:16 · KQTAB

Kan isatti amanu hundi jireenya bara baraa akka qabaatuuf malee akka hin badneef, Allaahan hamma Ilma isaa tokkicha kennutti addunyaa jaallateeraatii.

Nepali · Nepal

यूहन्ना 3:16 · NNRV

किनभने परमेश्वरले संसारलाई यस्तो प्रेम गर्नुभयो, कि उहाँले आफ्ना एकमात्र पुत्र दिनुभयो, ताकि उहाँमाथि विश्वास गर्ने कोही पनि नाश नहोस्, तर त्यसले अनन्त जीवन पाओस् ।

Dutch · Netherlands

Johannes 3:16 · HSV

Want zo lief heeft God de wereld gehad, dat Hij Zijn eniggeboren Zoon gegeven heeft, opdat ieder die in Hem gelooft, niet verloren gaat, maar eeuwig leven heeft.

John 3:16 in 48 languages

Panel 6 · In Every Language · 43–48 of 48 · 8 of 8

Romanian · Romania

Ioan 3:16 · CORNILESCU

Fiindcă atât de mult a iubit Dumnezeu lumea, că a dat pe singurul Lui Fiu, pentru ca oricine crede în El să nu piară, ci să aibă viața veșnică.

Sinhala · Sri Lanka

ජෝහන් 3:16 · SNRV 2018

දෙවියන් වහන්සේ ලෝකයාට කොතරම් ප්‍රේම කළ සේක් ද කිවොත්, ස්වකීය ඒක ජාතක පුත්‍රයාණන් වූව ද ලොවට දෙවා වදාළ සේක. එසේ කෙළේ, උන් වහන්සේ කෙරෙහි අදහන සියලු දෙනා ම විනාශ නොවී සදාතන ජීවනය ලබන පිණිස ය.

Khmer · Cambodia

យូហាន 3:16 · KSV 2005

ព្រះជាម្ចាស់ស្រឡាញ់មនុស្សលោកខ្លាំងណាស់ ហេតុនេះហើយបានជាព្រះអង្គប្រទានព្រះបុត្រាតែមួយរបស់ព្រះអង្គមក ដើម្បីអោយអ្នកដែលជឿលើព្រះបុត្រា មានជីវិតអស់កល្បជានិច្ច គឺមិនឲ្យគេវិនាសឡើយ។

Zulu · South Africa

Johane 3:16 · ZUL59

Ngokuba uNkulunkulu walithanda izwe kangaka, waze wanikela ngeNdodana yakhe ezelwe yodwa ukuba yilowo nalowo okholwa yiyo angabhubhi, kodwa abe nokuphila okuphakade.

Cebuano · Philippines

Juan 3:16 · ABCEB 2011

Kay gihigugma sa Dios ang kalibotan sa ingon nga tungod niana gihatag niya ang iyang bugtong Anak aron nga ang tanang motuo kaniya dili malaglag kondili makabaton sa kinabuhing dayon.

Pashto · Afghanistan

يوحنا 3:16 · APB

خدای د نړۍ سره وکړه مینه چې خپل یوازینی زوی یې ورکړ، ترڅو هرڅوک چې پرې هغه باندې ایمان راوړي، نو هلاک نه شي، بلکې تلپاتې ژوندون ولري.